Building processing time into teaching

Do I build in enough processing time?

ACCESSIBILITY / TEACHING

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Varied processing needs are accounted for in pace and structure, with processing time built in

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Accessibility is about usability, not just technical availability. A resource, room or activity can exist while still costing some students far more energy to perceive, navigate, understand or act on. Repeated friction sends a message about who the default user is.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “The information exists, but finding and using it takes more effort than learning it.”
- “I have to keep asking for a version I can actually use.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Pause after complex explanations and allow time to think.
- Chunk information and signpost transitions.
- Do not equate fast verbal response with understanding.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

A tutorial alternates short input with time to think, discuss or write before inviting contributions.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

In this course, we aim to build enough processing time into teaching so students can think before they are expected to respond. If the way a class or learning activity is organised makes it harder for you to participate or…

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